

EasyLight Charcoal

Charcoal that lights itself — one packaging fix that made a boring product go viral.

What It Is

A premium barbecue charcoal brand built on smart packaging. Like Brazil's Braza, you add a small wooden base board under the charcoal and a built-in wick so customers can light the whole bundle in one move — no lighter fluid, no dirty hands, no fuss. The food-safe paper doesn't taint flavor. The charcoal itself is unchanged; you simply solved the most annoying part of every cookout.

How It Makes Money

You sell ready-to-light charcoal bundles at a premium over loose bags, to home grillers and campers who hate the mess. Revenue from retail grocery/hardware placement, DTC and Amazon, camping/outdoor retailers, and convenience stores near parks and beaches. The "light it with one match" demo is your free marketing.

Startup Costs

- Bulk lump/briquette charcoal (Alibaba: "hardwood charcoal briquette bulk" / "BBQ charcoal manufacturer"): \$0.20–\$0.45 per lb landed
- Food-safe wrapping paper + wooden base board + wick: \$0.30–\$0.60 per bundle
- Packaging/printing with branding: \$0.20–\$0.45 per bundle (Alibaba: "custom kraft charcoal bag printing")
- Assembly/sealing equipment or co-packer: \$500–\$3,000
- Sea freight + duty on first container/pallet order: \$800–\$2,500
- Branding, Shopify/Amazon listing, photography + demo video: \$600–\$1,500
- Permits/business setup + product testing: \$500–\$1,500
- **Total to launch: \$4,000–\$11,000**

The Numbers

- Cost per ready-to-light bundle (3–4 lb): charcoal ~~\$1.00–\$1.60~~ + board/wick/paper ~~\$0.70~~ + packaging ~~\$0.35~~ = ~~**\$2.10–\$2.65**~~
- Retail sell price: \$7–\$11 per bundle
- Wholesale price to stores: \$4.00–\$5.50
- Profit per bundle: DTC/retail \$4.50–\$8; wholesale \$1.50–\$3
- Sell 4,000–7,000 bundles/month across retail + DTC = **\$20,000–\$45,000 revenue, \$9,000–\$22,000 profit/month** in grilling season.

How To Start

1. Source quality hardwood charcoal and a food-safe wrapping paper from Alibaba; order samples and test burn quality and flavor.
2. Design the all-in-one bundle: charcoal + wooden base + wick wrapped in printed food-safe paper that lights from the bottom.
3. Test light-time and burn safety repeatedly; the one-match demo must work every time.

4. Set up assembly (in-house or co-packer) and order a first production run.
5. Build an Amazon + Shopify listing led by a clean "light it in 10 seconds" demo video.
6. Pitch local grocers, hardware stores, campgrounds, and beach-town convenience stores for shelf space.
7. Push the demo reel on social — solving the messy-charcoal pain point is inherently shareable.

Where To Get Customers

Amazon and DTC (Shopify); grocery, hardware, and outdoor retailers; campgrounds, beach/park convenience stores, and tackle shops; Instagram/TikTok demo videos; barbecue and camping communities; gas stations near recreation areas for impulse buys.

Pro Tips

- The demo is the product — a flawless one-match light video sells better than any feature list, so over-engineer reliability and film it endlessly.
- Place near the use moment: convenience stores by parks, beaches, and campgrounds sell impulse bundles at full margin to people who forgot fluid.
- Get proper food-contact and burn-safety testing done early; charcoal is a combustible consumer good and a failed safety claim ends the brand.